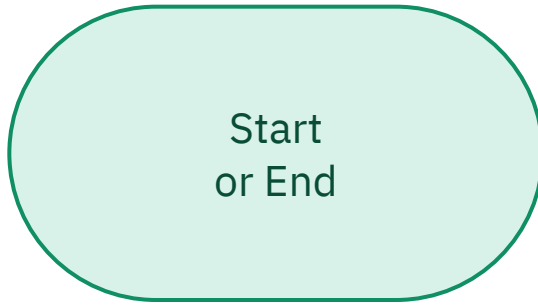
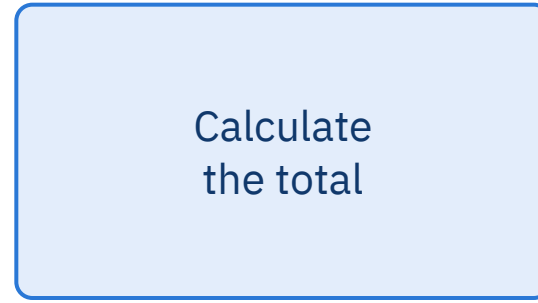


# Flowchart Symbols

A small, shared vocabulary. The shape tells you what kind of step it is.



**OVAL**  
Where the process begins  
and where it stops



**RECTANGLE**  
A step. Something happens  
and then you move on.



**DIAMOND**  
A decision. Two ways out,  
labelled Yes and No.



**ARROW** — which step runs next. Every shape needs at least one arrow leaving it, except the end.

One more you will meet: a PARALLELOGRAM — a slanted rectangle — means input or output, such as "read the expense amount" or "print the receipt".

*Flowcharts are excellent for decisions and dead ends, and clumsy for anything long. That is why programmers usually switch to pseudocode.*